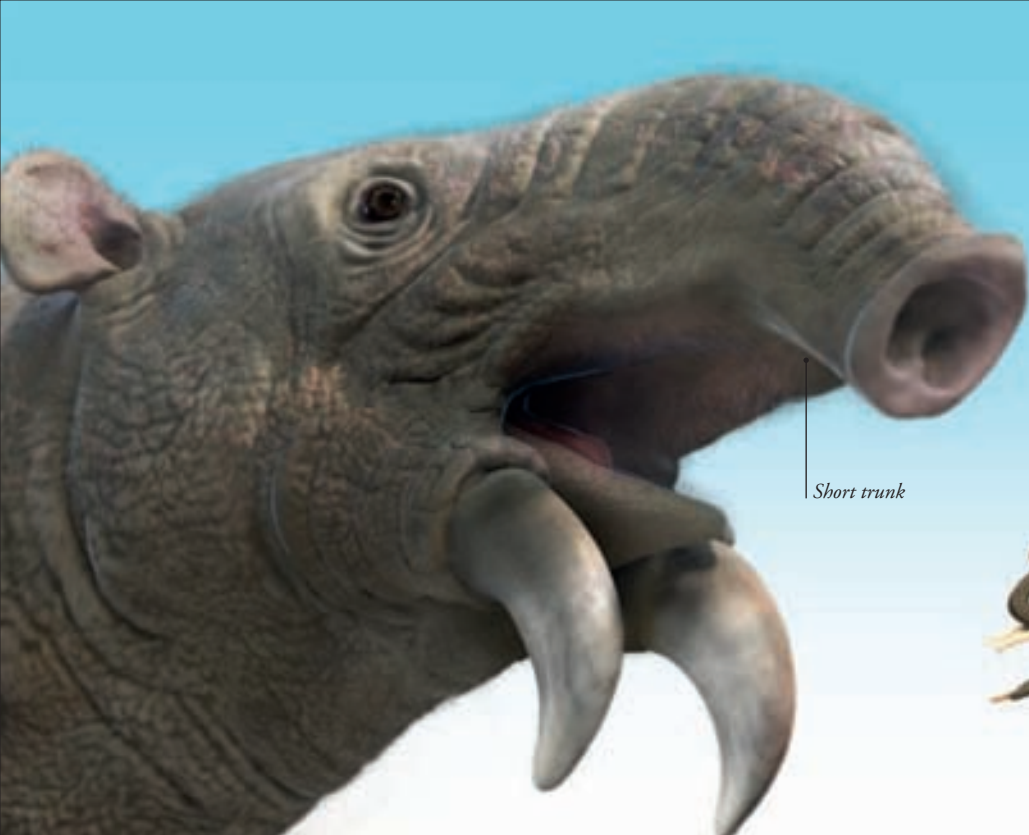




Gomphotherium

GOM-foe-THEE-ree-um



- **When** 15–5 million years ago (Neogene)
- **Fossil location** N. America, Europe, Asia, Africa
- **Habitat** Swamps
- **Height** 10 ft (3 m) tall at the shoulder
- **Diet** Plants

Gomphotherium had two pairs of tusks—one pair extending from its upper jaw, and another smaller, shovel-shaped pair growing out of its lower jaw. The larger tusks were probably used for fighting and display, and the smaller ones to scrape up plants and strip tree bark.



Moeritherium

MEH-ree-THEER-ee-um



- **When** 37–30 million years ago (Paleogene)
- **Fossil location** Egypt
- **Habitat** Swamps
- **Length** 10 ft (3 m)
- **Diet** Plants



Moeritherium was a close cousin of the elephant family and had the beginnings of a trunk. It was much smaller than modern elephants and had a long body with very short legs. It perhaps lived like a hippo, wallowing in lakes and rivers and feeding on water plants, using its flexible lips to grasp stems. The large teeth in both its upper and lower jaws formed small tusks that jutted out of its mouth.

Arsinoitherium

AR-sin-oh-ee-THEER-ee-um



- **When** 35–30 million years ago (Paleogene)
- **Fossil location** Africa
- **Habitat** Plains
- **Height** 6 ft (2 m) tall at the shoulder
- **Diet** Plants

Arsinoitherium belonged to an extinct family of mammals that was related to the elephant family, but it was not an elephant. It had no trunk and looked like a rhino, with two huge horns on its snout that were likely used by males for display or fights over females.

Arsinoitherium's hind legs were crooked and perhaps better suited to a life wallowing in water than walking on land.



Arsinoitherium's huge double horn was hollow.

Platybelodon

PLAT-ee-BELL-oh-don



- **When** 10–6 million years ago (Neogene)
- **Fossil location** N. America, Africa, Asia, Europe
- **Habitat** Plains
- **Height** 10 ft (3 m) tall at the shoulder
- **Diet** Plants



The lower tusks of *Platybelodon* ("shovel tusk") were flat and close together, forming a shovel—perhaps used to scoop up plants from water or marshes. Wear marks on the lower tusks show that it also used its tusks as blades to slice across branches. Like modern elephants, *Platybelodon* had columnlike legs supporting its body. It also had fatty pads under its feet that helped to bear its massive weight.

